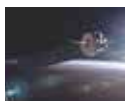




Bot snitches on Venmo drug buyers

A Twitter bot @venmodrugs is hunting down drug transactions on Venmo and publicly shaming those who buy them. <https://dgit.in/Aug18-23-1>



Momentum test flight in 2019

Momentum, a propulsion technology developer working on water as fuel to have first test flight in early 2019. <https://dgit.in/Aug18-23-2>

well as smartphone brands themselves to facilitate better rates and faster repair times. Startups like Gadgetwood, SSPAdvantage and BigFix are offering similar services. Essentially, for almost all of these startups, you sign up on their platforms, choose your device, select a repair package and schedule a pick up. Some startups like JustLikeNew also have dedicated offline stores you can walk into for a repair.

Another segment where these startups are trying to make headway is the sale of refurbished gadgets. Once you decide that the damage to your phone is too extensive and you'd like to go for a new device, these startups are willing to buy the device off you, repair it and sell it as a refurbished unit - which is a win-win situation as compared to letting a broken device be stashed away somewhere in your home.

For a startup like JustLikeNew and SSPAdvantage, the next frontier would be corporate repair agreements. A number of major companies offer devices to their employees in bulk, and hence, require a large volume of standardised, quick, easy to track repair services - which these startups can provide. When it comes to the individual, though, even a smooth repair process can feel like a pinch if it happens too frequently. If you're tired of paying up each and every time your device gets damaged or breaks, there's something else you can do to avoid that - insure it.

GADGET INSURANCE

The insurance sector in India is currently in a state of disruption, thanks to a number of insurtech startups. These startups are digitising a previously 90%-offline driven sector and bringing it online. Along with that, they are offering policies that are better aimed at the modern millennial with purchasing power. Which brings us to gadget insurance.

While repair startups are speeding up the repair process, insurance startups are offering agreements that remove the need for you to pay up each time something goes wrong with your

UNIQUE INSURANCE POLICIES THAT YOU CAN BUY IN INDIA

Some of the startups that offer to insure your gadgets also offer some unique insurance policies in India:

- **Cab ride insurance (Acko on Ola)** - If you've taken cab rides on Ola recently, you might have noticed an option to secure your ride with ride insurance. These go from Rs.1 for a normal ride to Rs.10 for a rental ride and more, and cover a number of things like hospitalisation, delays, loss of baggage etc.
- **Fitness insurance (Toffee)** - Specialising in bite sized insurance backed by established providers, Toffee offers a fitness insurance for any injuries incurred due to running, cycling, gyming & more. It covers hospitalisation, ambulance charges and more.
- **Jewellery Insurance (Digit)** - No, that's not us. Go Digit General Insurance allows you to insure your bling against theft, damage and is valid on losses incurred worldwide.

device. Take Acko, for instance. When you're purchasing a new smartphone on Amazon, you might notice the option to add an All-Round Mobile Protection Pack for the device that covers a lot, from cracked screens, liquid damage, free pick-up and drop for in-warranty repairs and more. What's more, in certain cities, for every day over the guaranteed 7 days it takes to repair the device, you get Amazon vouchers worth ₹500. And that's just one example.

These options are not limited to smartphones. There are startups like Koverup that aim to cover a wider spectrum of gadgets. This Pune based startup, among other options, aims to cover more than just your smartphone. Although the product is still not live, their comprehensive gadget insurance options also aim to cover tablets, laptops, cameras and smartwatches.

Sometimes, your gadgets are insured as a part of other policies that you might have availed. Home insurance often covers damage due to fire, flooding and other unavoidable circumstances and is applicable to your electronic appliances and gadgets as well. Another way of insuring your gadget would be to take out travel insurance for when you're travelling. These policies generally cover loss or damage to belongings and should be good for your smartphone and laptop,

but always read the fine print before opting for a particular policy.

GOING FORWARD

Startups like Go Digit (again, not us) can already remotely check your phone for basic diagnostics, but the future of gadget care lies beyond that. Right now, this segment in the world of technology could practically go anywhere. While most devices, especially smartphones, aren't exactly built to be durable, there could be newer, damage resistant materials being used in the future - some that can even repair themselves! On the other hand, gadget usage isn't set to go down any time soon - people are buying gadgets, even high end ones, increasingly in our country. So the demand for a more accessible, organised and visible way to get your gadgets repaired and insured isn't going away any time soon. If you are starting to feel that this push will eventually hurt local smartphone repair shops and small scale entrepreneurs and their employees, then you'd be wrong. Most of these startups work with a network of local shops that offer repair services at a fixed, reasonable rate in lieu of guaranteed business. So, essentially, there are a number of ways to take care of your gadgets than cleaning them occasionally or slapping a case onto them. The question is, how much do you really care about them? 